

Main

Report Name (Org_Country_Year_Report Type)

TEC_Tanzania_2024-25_3-month Report

Fellowship Organization

Tanzania Education Corporation (TEC)

Fellowship City

Makuyuni

Fellowship Country

Tanzania

Fellowship Start Date

08/06/2024

Anticipated Fellowship End Date

08/06/2025

What is your fellowship title/role?

STEM Fellow

What are your primary responsibilities?

Teaching lessons on STEM topics to secondary students, organizing extracurricular activities for STEM students such as STEM club and Photography club, editing and improving curriculum for Project Based Learning courses, editing photos and videos for social media

I receive adequate direction and support to perform my fellowship responsibilities.

Agree

Did you receive any sort of orientation, handover or onboarding when you started your fellowship?

Somewhat

Please describe your orientation/onboarding and note who handled it.**If you did not receive any kind of orientation, what information or guidance were you provided at the start of your fellowship?****Describe a representative day at work.**

I start the day with a meeting with all staff and faculty at the school to receive school updates, next I work on planning my future lessons and extracurricular activities, after an hour lunch break with other teachers at school, I work on curriculum edits for Project Based Learning and activities for classes such as field trips and site visits

On average, how many hours per week do you work?

30

How would you describe your effectiveness in your fellowship post so far?

Effective

Please briefly describe 1-2 specific projects that you have undertaken or accomplishments you have made so far.

Worked on integrating Khan Academy into Form 5 classes so students will have a level of independence while still learning about STEM topics, worked on improving curriculum for a Project Based Learning course based on UN sustainable development goals

What is your organization's work culture like?**What is your office environment like? Please comment on the size and structure of the office(s) where you do most of your work.**

The office environment is very open and collaborative. We are based in a small office inside of the STEM lab, but enjoy the open space of the STEM lab when students are not in class. The STEM lab is on the school campus and is an open campus with plenty of outdoor space.

To whom do you report?

-Supervisor, who manages what is expected from us and big updates
-On the ground supervisor in Tanzania, who checks in almost daily on what we are working on and answers any specific questions

Have you had an initial check-in with your supervisor to set up a work plan and to set goals for your work during your fellowship year?

Yes

Was this meeting helpful in understanding your role and setting goals for your fellowship year?**Please explain why you have not met with your supervisor and if you have plans to do so going forward.****Please briefly indicate 3-5 professional goals you have for the rest of your fellowship year. Your professional goals should align with your work plan.**

Improving communication, becoming a mentor for students, project management

How often do you check in with your supervisor?

Weekly

Have you had an opportunity to travel for work so far?

Yes

Describe this travel opportunity. Include location(s) and a brief description of the purpose of the trip(s).

Arusha for collecting STEM materials, but it is only an hour and half away so I am not sure if it counts

I feel adequately prepared for my position's professional responsibilities.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response.

I believe my computer science major prepared me for the technical requirements of my role and that my internship experience have prepared me for the professional aspects.

How did you travel to your host country and site? Please be specific

I purchased and flew Delta airlines. I flew from JFK to Boston, Boston to Amsterdam, and Amsterdam to JRO through KLM/Delta partner. The round trip ticket cost \$1781

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

Business Visa

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

Lawyer arranges the visa

Did you apply for and receive your visa / permit before heading to your host country or after arriving?

No, I got it upon arrival (business visa), but prepared documents before

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

\$250

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

Reimbursed by organization

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

No

If yes, please explain further

g) Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

Have cash ready to pay for it, and bring USD in case of any issues at any airport in general

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure? How much did your vaccinations cost? Did you get a yellow fever vaccination?

I got yellow fever last year, which I would recommend for traveling throughout Africa, but not necessary for Tanzania

How was your arrival and first week in your host country? Any improvements that could streamline the assimilation process for future Fellows?

My arrival was organized well by my supervisors and I was transferred from Kilimanjaro Airport to Karatu, where Cece helped me with my orientation. It involved learning more about my responsibilities, before going to Makuyuni two days later, where I am based out of. I learned mostly just based on experience, so I wish there was a bit more hands on training, but I learned quickly

Is housing provided by and/or paid for by your organization? Please explain.

Yes, it is and it is based on the campus of the school I work from.

Do you live in a location that is more urban or rural?

Somewhat Rural

Please describe your living environment

I live in a small town, which has a couple restaurants and gas station, as well as a weekly market since it is a transit hub. I would consider it somewhat rural just because it is close to Arusha, a small city and easily accessible for anything I would need.

How do you typically travel between your home and your work? How much does your daily transportation cost and how long is your commute?

It is 3 minutes walking since I live where I work

If you live in a more rural area, what are the closest urban areas you can travel to for shopping, airport, larger medical centers, etc.?

Arusha is the closest area and it costs \$2 on public transport and \$20 for private car, around an hour and a half.

How is the weather in your host country? What season are you presently in?

We are currently in the short rainy season but also summer, so it is hot and rains a bit which cools things down, but usually 90 F everyday and pretty dry where I live. In Arusha and Karatu it rains more and is greener.

What is the appropriate clothing for work and outside of work at your fellowship post and in your community in general?

Tanzania is a religious country, so I wear a skirt and blouse (sometimes basic t-shirt) to work and linen trousers once in a while. In my town, I wear this almost always outside of work or trousers with a t shirt. When exercising I cover my entire body with long leggings and a loose t shirt. Outside of my town (in Arusha), I wear pants or capris with a tank top if it's hot, but always bring a light cover up.

How have you been spending your free time?

I have spent my free time in my town reading, working on studying for the LSAT and running, as well as spending time with other teachers after work having tea in the evenings or watching football. On the weekends, I go to Arusha where I spend time exploring with friends I have made there.

I've been able to successfully navigate my personal/social life both back at home and at my fellowship post.

Strongly Agree

Please briefly explain your response below.

I set up weekly calls with my friends from home, some have visited me here, and I have made an effort to connect and follow up with people in Arusha, as well as spending time with my coworkers during the week and getting off of the school campus.

Would you say you live and work in a safe area?

Yes, there are low levels of crime, though women are not expected to go out alone too much.

What precautions do you take to ensure your safety?

I carry pepper spray with me when running alone, and shared my location with friends here.

What has been your experience with crime so far? (Please note that any security or safety concerns or incidents should be reported directly to PiAf staff per PiAf safety and security protocol.)

N/A

Describe the incidence of crime and the general security situation within your city/town. Could you recommend specific areas future Fellows might consider for safe housing? What about areas that should be avoided?

There has been no crime that I have noticed here, however I live near a major highway where there are rumors of organ trafficking, so I would be careful spending time walking on it alone without letting anyone know where you are.

Please refer back to the goals you set for yourself before orientation. Are you working towards these goals? Have you met any of them? Changed any of them? Please explain.

I am still working towards my goals, but have changed one to providing mentorship for students, which I am going to work on more this upcoming term now that I am settled in. Communication is gone well and I have become better at communicating in an effective manner with my supervisor and coworkers.

Do you have any frustrations with your living arrangements, your work or your life outside of work?

Yes, but nothing that is different from what I experienced in the US. No situation is perfect, but thankfully my frustrations are minimal.

Has there been anything that you have needed but have not been able to locate or acquire?

Nope!

How have you dealt with "culture shock"?

I honestly did not experience much culture shock to my surprise, but I think that reminding myself about why I chose this experience really helped me reconnect when I felt lost or confused.

What about your experience thus far has been the most...surprising?

The political environment of Tanzania

What about your experience thus far has been the most...challenging?

Understanding expectations of women in Tanzanian society and what women are supposed to be comfortable with.

What are the top 3 things you miss the most from your home country or the U.S.?

Caribbean food, the subway (never thought I would say this), my gym

What are the top 3 things about life in your host country that beat out life in your home country or the U.S.?

Nature, friendliness, cost

How is your stipend being paid?

Paid monthly in USD to a US account

How are you receiving your stipend funds?

Wire

Did you raise funds to cover part of your fellowship expenses?

Nope, I saved a lot before coming

Please list any additional one-time or infrequent expenses not included in your monthly budget below.

Monthly Budget

Rent	Utilities	Furnishings	Phone	Home Security	Internet
\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$15.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
Transportation	Fitness	Entertainment	Groceries	House Cleaning	Eating Out
\$30.00	\$20.00	\$50.00	\$30.00	\$10.00	\$30.00
Medications	Additional Health Insurance	Travel	Laundry	Other	Total Monthly Budget (Minus Entertainment & Travel)
\$15.00	\$0.00	\$200.00	\$15.00	\$0.00	165.00
Specify "Other"					

Final Thoughts

Please briefly explain your response about Orientation.

I think the helpful part of orientation was meeting previous fellows who had been in my country/region in a breakout room, but besides that the Zoom format made it difficult to stay focused at times, and to connect with fellows in my cohort.

Is there anything in particular that PiAf could cover at orientation that would have better prepared you for your fellowship post? Please specify.

N/A

Are you receiving sufficient support, materials and information from the Princeton in Africa office? What could we improve?

N/A

As we plan the upcoming PiAf Retreat, we hope to incorporate some Fellow suggestions into our programming. What are some topics or sessions you would like to see at the Retreat? (We appreciate your feedback however, we may not be able to accommodate all suggestions or requests this year.)

N/A